The human digestive system is pretty amazing.

Turning the food we eat into fuel the body uses for energy and to help us grow. However sometimes even small changes in our everyday routine can get in the way of healthy digestion.



Digestion begins as soon as food enters into the mouth.

1 Mouth:

Three pairs of salivary glands secrets saliva.
Enzymes in the saliva mix with food particles and start breaking them down while chewing.

2 Oesophagus:

The oesophagus is a tube connecting the mouth to the stomach. After swallow, the food travels down through the esophagus to the stomach.

Do you know?
The oesophagus takes your chewed food and squeezes it downward using muscle contractions called peristalsis.

3 Cardiac sphincter:

The Cardiac sphincter is where the oesophagus meets the stomach. This group of muscles acts like a gate to prevent stomach acid from going back up (refluxing) into the oesophagus.

4 Stomach:

Gastric juice contain HCl and gastric enzymes.

Hydrochloric acid (HCl) helps to digest proteins and other foods by pepsin enzymes while minimizing harmful bacteria.

5 Liver:

The liver secrete bile. Bile helps the small intestine by breaking downs fats and making them easier to absorb.

Gall bladder stores bile secretion. 6

Do you know? The liver is also an important detoxification organ. It helps to filter and elimate harmful toxins from our body.

7 Pancreas

The pancreas is connected to the duodenum where three important digestive enzmyes are made:

Protease	Lipase	Amylase
Helps digest protein	Helps digest fats	Helps digest carbohydrates

Fun fact:
There are two kinds of fibre, and both support a healthy colon.

Soluble fibre	Insolube fibre
soaks up toxins and waste in the digestive system	("roughage") moves bulk through the intestine to help with regular bowel movements.

8 Small intestine:

Most of the nutrients form food are digested and absorbed in the small intestine.

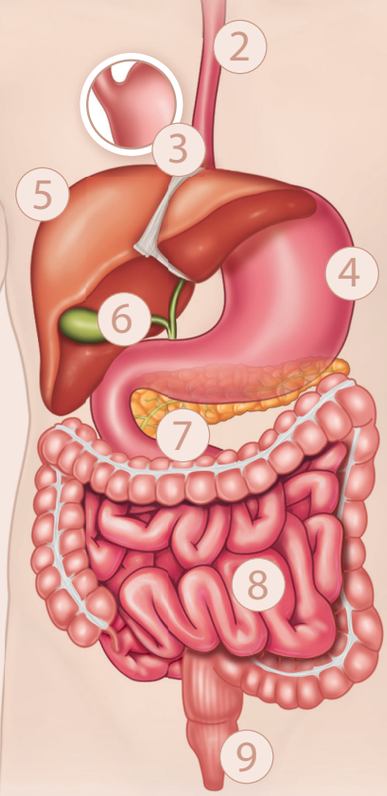
Do you know?
Small intestine is lined with mucosa, a layer of tissue that helps to absorb nutrients, produce digestive enzymes, and make mucus to protect the delicate intestinal wall.

9 Large intestine (Colon):

Most of the bacteria living in the digestive tract can be found in the large intestine. This is where the digestive process comes to an end.

Do you know?
Digestive system associated disorders are gastritis, bloating, diarrhoea, constipation, heartburn and acid reflux, jaundice, gall stones obesity, etc...





There are more then **100 trillion** bacterial cells in your body.



The digestive tract is home to a natural balance of good, bad, and neutral bacteria.

Do you know?
Good bacteria, also called probiotics, support overall digestive and immune health.

Do you know? Up to 70% of our natural immune system support is in the digestive tract.

Here are 5 simple things you can do every day to maintain a healthy, balanced gut:



TN_GOVT_XI_Bio Zoology_Ch05.indd 87 09-01-2020 5.27.58 PM